

Robert Puffe

DevOps Lead · AWS · CI/CD · Terraform

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SUMMARY

DevOps Lead at a healthcare SaaS company: 10 years in production IT, promoted three times from IT support up to DevOps Lead, with 5 years of hands-on AWS work. I own the CI/CD platform for two production healthcare products, with standardized deployment pipelines across 10 environments on GitHub Actions and AWS CodePipeline, and infrastructure as code in Terraform, run as a HIPAA-compliant platform. Within the wider organization, I consult on infrastructure for smaller product teams.

Coming up through customer-facing IT, I'm comfortable in front of customers and business leaders, not just terminals, and I bring that range to supporting engineering teams and building the tooling behind them.

EXPERIENCE

Eldermark (LivTech) | Healthcare SaaS · Remote

DevOps Lead

Apr 2026 – Present

DevOps Engineer

Mar 2024 – Apr 2026

- Own CI/CD end to end for two production platforms (clinical and eMAR), supporting a 40+ person engineering org as half of a two-person DevOps team: standardized pipelines across 10 environments handling both full-platform deploys and targeted per-service releases (frontend, API, org), plus automated staging restore pipelines on CodePipeline.
- Operate production AWS across 8 accounts under HIPAA: ECS/Fargate services (Spring Boot), Lambda, RDS/Aurora, IAM, VPC networking, and CloudWatch, with a smaller secondary footprint on EKS.
- Redesigned the CI/CD pipeline architecture, rebuilding hand-created sequential pipelines as reusable Terraform modules and cutting roughly 20 minutes of downtime from every full production deployment.
- Leading the migration of infrastructure-as-code from AWS Copilot to Terraform, converting live production services module by module without downtime.
- Built a deployment tracker (Lambda, packaged as a reusable Terraform module) that parses git history on every deploy, updates the matching Jira tickets, and posts Teams notifications, removing manual status coordination between QA and development.
- Replaced a manual, multi-system environment refresh with a push-button CodePipeline, saving hours of work per refresh and removing human error from production database restores.
- Own branching strategy and release management across the GitHub organization: branch models, staged promotion, and versioned container images and shared base images in ECR.
- Review infrastructure and deployment changes early in the SDLC, catching architecture and deployment risks before they reach an environment.
- Partner with leadership on security audits and penetration-test remediation, and implement infrastructure and container security practices that meet compliance and reliability requirements.
- Drove the division's adoption of AI development tooling: rolled out Cursor to the engineering team and established automated AI code reviews with CodeRabbit, GitHub Copilot, and Codex.
- Build internal self-service tooling: a CLI that lets engineering managers run manual deployments to lower environments themselves, and a user-creation tool that lets support staff provision users for the emergency forms product — removing DevOps as a bottleneck for routine requests.

System Administrator

May 2021 – Mar 2024

- Carried DevOps responsibilities alongside sysadmin work: environment and pipeline management across the company's growing AWS footprint.
- Migrated workloads to AWS using EC2, S3, Transfer Family, and Terraform.
- Led the transition of the DevOps function in-house, improving efficiency and reducing cost.

IT Specialist

Sep 2016 – May 2021

- Customer-facing technical support: joined sales and customer calls to answer technical questions, demonstrate the product, and support customer migration projects.
- Led the company's transition to remote work during the pandemic, keeping teams productive without interruption.

SKILLS

Cloud (AWS): ECS/Fargate, Lambda, RDS/Aurora, IAM, VPC, CloudWatch, CodePipeline, ECR**IaC & automation:** Terraform, Python, Bash, PowerShell, SQL (Liquibase)**CI/CD & source control:** GitHub Actions, AWS CodePipeline, Git, GitHub org administration, branching models**Containers:** Docker, ECS/Fargate (primary), EKS (secondary)**Practices:** HIPAA compliance, release management, observability (CloudWatch, ELK), DR documentation, Jira, Agile